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TOWNSHIP OF MAPLEWOOD, NEW JERSEY

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT & DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS

Comprehensive Municipal Permit, Required Documents & 311 Service Request Manual

The authoritative municipal manual governing Uniform Construction Code (UCC) permits, mandatory documentation checklists for every permit type, specialized zoning and engineering reviews, and the official citizen 311 service request intake standards.

Part I: Construction Permits

NJ Uniform Construction Code (N.J.A.C. 5:23), mandatory subcodes, plan criteria, and Town Hall 24/7 drop box intake.

Part II: Required Documents

Itemized checklists for decks, pools, fences, additions, tree removal (Ch. 227), street dumpsters, and road openings.

Part III: 311 Service Requests

Pothole reporting data criteria, response SLAs, 50-meter duplicate detection, and 4-stage work order lifecycle tracking.

PUBLIC CITIZEN & CONTRACTOR COMPLIANCE NOTICE:
This document serves as the regulatory standard for all property owners, licensed contractors, and municipal service agents. Failure to secure prior permits or furnish required documentation constitutes a violation of Maplewood Township Code and New Jersey State Statutes.

DEPARTMENTAL OFFICES & INTAKE:
Maplewood Town Hall • Construction & Engineering
574 Valley Street, Maplewood, NJ 07040
Building: (973) 762-8120 | DPW / 311 Desk: (973) 762-1175
Online Portal: GovPilot Digital Intake & 311 Citizen Request Desk

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Chapter 1: The New Jersey Uniform Construction Code (UCC)

The Township of Maplewood Construction Division enforces the **New Jersey Uniform Construction Code (N.J.A.C. 5:23)**. The UCC establishes uniform structural, fire, electrical, plumbing, and mechanical safety standards for all residential and commercial buildings within the municipality.

WHEN IS A MUNICIPAL CONSTRUCTION PERMIT MANDATORY?

Pursuant to state statute, property owners or licensed contractors must obtain an approved Construction Permit before beginning any of the following scopes of work:

Structural & Building Additions

- Constructing new homes, room additions, or dormers
- Interior alterations, wall removals, finishing basements/attics
- New kitchen or bathroom layout reconfigurations
- Constructing or replacing outdoor decks or porches
- Roof replacements and whole-house siding installations
- Installing sheds or accessory structures > 100 sq ft
- Demolition of primary dwellings, sheds, or garages

Mechanical, Electrical & Utilities

- New heating systems, furnaces, boilers, heat pumps
- Central air conditioning installations or replacements
- Water heater replacements (tank or tankless)
- Electrical service panel upgrades (100A to 200A+)
- Whole-house backup generators and solar panel arrays
- Gas line extensions, conversions, or fireplace inserts
- Automatic lawn sprinkler systems (backflow preventer)

APPLICATION SUBMISSION METHODS: GOVPILOT & TOWN HALL DROP BOX

Applications may be submitted electronically via the **Maplewood Online Application Forms portal (GovPilot)** on `maplewoodnj.gov`. Paper UCC application jackets and subcode technical sections (Building, Electric, Plumbing, Fire) can also be submitted in person or placed into the **24/7 Secure Permit Drop Box located at the Park Road side entrance of Maplewood Town Hall**.

MANDATORY DIGITAL INSPECTION REQUEST PROCESS:
All inspection requests must be submitted online using the Township's digital **Inspection Request Form** on `maplewoodnj.gov`. Inspections are scheduled within statutory timeframes upon completion of each construction stage: rough framing, rough electric, rough plumbing, insulation, and final approvals. Work must not be covered prior to subcode inspector sign-off.

Chapter 2: Itemized Checklist of Documents Required by Permit Type

To prevent application delays, the Construction Division enforces strict submittal standards. Incomplete packages will not be accepted for technical plan review. Below are the mandatory required documents for each primary permit classification:

PERMIT CLASSIFICATION	MANDATORY REQUIRED DOCUMENTS CHECKLIST	STATUTORY CODES & NOTES
Residential Decks & Porches	• UCC Form F100 (Folder) & Building Subcode F110 • Scaled certified property survey showing setbacks to all property lines • Two (2) complete sets of structural framing plans (joist spans, beam sizes, ledger bolt pattern, flashing details) • Pier footing cross-section (min. 36″ frost depth, soil bearing) • Guardrail and handrail details (min. 36″ height, 4″ sphere spacing)	Zoning prior approval required. Footing inspection mandatory before pouring concrete.
Swimming Pools & Spas (In-ground / Above-ground >24″)	• UCC Forms F100, Building F110, Electrical F120, Plumbing F130 • Certified plot plan with proposed pool location & impervious coverage • Manufacturer specifications & structural engineering calculations • Pool safety barrier plan: 48″ non-climbable fence, self-closing/latching gates opening outward • Electrical equipotential bonding grid plan & audible door alarm specs	N.J.A.C. 5:23 Subchapter 8. Requires rough trench, bonding, and barrier inspections.
Fences & Retaining Walls	• Zoning Compliance Application (`ZP-2026`) • Scaled property survey showing exact fence alignment and height • Manufacturer cut-sheet showing style, height, and materials • For fences >6 ft or retaining walls >4 ft: UCC Building Subcode F110 and sealed engineering structural stability calculations	Finished/smooth side must face neighbors. Standard fences ≤6 ft exempt from UCC building permit.
Home Additions & Finished Basements	• UCC Forms F100, F110 (Building), F120 (Electric), F130 (Plumbing) • Two (2) complete sets of architectural plans sealed by NJ licensed architect • Foundation, framing, cross-sections, and wall-bracing details • Emergency escape/egress window details (min. 5.7 sq ft, sill ≤44″) • REScheck energy compliance calculations and smoke detector layout	Zoning approval mandatory prior to UCC review. Mandatory inspections at all 5 milestone stages.
Roofing & Siding Replacement	• UCC Form F100 & Building Subcode Technical Section F110 • Material specification sheets (shingle fire rating, underlayment type) • Ice-and-water shield details (min. 24″ past interior wall line) • Verification of existing roof layers (max. 2 layers permitted by code) • House-wrap and moisture barrier details for siding jobs	Stripping existing layers to decking requires sheathing inspection if rot detected.
HVAC & Water Heaters (Furnaces, Boilers, AC, Heaters)	• UCC Form F100, Plumbing F130, Electrical F120, Fire F140 • Manufacturer equipment efficiency data sheet and BTU ratings • Chimney verification form (for gas appliance venting into masonry) • Gas line sizing schematic (if increasing BTU input)	Emergency replacements permitted with permit application filed within 72 hours.

HOMEOWNER DRAWING EXEMPTION: Under NJ UCC (N.J.A.C. 5:23-2.15), owner-occupants of single-family detached dwellings may draft their own architectural plans for deck, basement, or addition work, provided plans are neat, dimensioned, to scale, and include an executed Homeowner Certification. Work on multi-family dwellings or commercial properties requires drawings sealed by a NJ licensed architect or professional engineer.

Chapter 3: Specialized Permits: Forestry, Dumpsters & Engineering

PRIVATE TREE REMOVAL PERMITS (TOWNSHIP CODE CHAPTER 227)

The Township strictly regulates tree removals on private property to preserve its suburban forest canopy. A formal permit is mandatory before removing any tree measuring **12 inches or more in caliper (DBH)**.

Tree Removal Mandatory Document Checklist

- **Completed Tree Permit Form:** Species, DBH caliper, condition, and location.
- **Registered Contractor Verification:** Selected from official Registered Tree List.
- **Contractor Insurance:** COI showing min. $1,000,000 liability naming Township.
- **Certified Mail Receipts:** Postmarked slips sent to all abutting neighbors within 200 ft.
- **Mitigation Plan:** 1:1 replacement plan or proof of $375 Tree Fund deposit.

Mandatory Replacement or $375 Contribution

For every permitted tree removed, the applicant must satisfy one statutory mitigation condition:

- **Option A (1-to-1 Native Replanting):** Plant an approved native shade tree (min. 2.5-inch caliper) on property within 6 months.
- **Option B (Municipal Tree Trust Fund):** Pay replacement contribution of **$375.00 per tree** into Municipal Tree Bank.

Note: Certified mailings to abutting neighbors are required regardless of tree health.

PUBLIC STREET DUMPSTERS & TEMPORARY STORAGE CONTAINERS (PODS)

Placing roll-off debris containers, Bagsters, or portable storage units (PODs) on municipal property requires strict compliance with Chapter 257:

Private Driveway Placement

NO PERMIT REQUIRED

If the container is positioned entirely on private property (inside driveway) without encroaching on public sidewalk or roadway, no permit or fee is required.

Public Street Placement

MANDATORY $50 PERMIT

Placing a container in roadway requires DPW & Police Traffic approval. Maximum duration: **7 calendar days** (1 renewal permitted).

STREET DUMPSTER REQUIRED SUBMISSION DOCUMENTS:

- Completed DPW Container Application (`DPW-CT-01`) filed at least 3 business days in advance.
- Certificate of Insurance (COI) naming *Township of Maplewood* as additional insured ($300,000 liability).
- Flat fee of **$50.00** per 7-day period. Reflective markers & amber flashers mandatory. Prohibited on snow routes.

ENGINEERING ROAD OPENING & UTILITY EXCAVATION PERMITS

PERMIT TYPE	DOCUMENTS & SUBMISSIONS REQUIRED	RESTORATION & PERFORMANCE STANDARDS
Street Opening / Road Cut	Application ENG-RO-01, 811 Dig-Safe ticket, $150 filing fee, $1,500 escrow/bond, $1M contractor COI.	Mandatory infrared seamless asphalt pavement restoration. 90-day temporary settlement followed by 1-year final saw-cut patch.
Sewer Lateral Connection	Plumbing subcode permit, Engineering review, scaled riser diagram, trench safety plan, licensed plumber credentials.	Air pressure testing and DPW inspection prior to backfill. Connection must utilize approved saddle onto main sewer.
Driveway Apron / Curb Cut	Zoning compliance form, plot plan with dimensions, slope drainage schematic, concrete contractor licensing.	Minimum 6-inch reinforced concrete (4,000 PSI) with expansion joints at sidewalk and curb interfaces.

Chapter 4: 311 Citizen Municipal Service Requests — Pothole Intake

FAQ: "I want to create a service request for a pothole — what information do you need?"

When submitting a service request for a pothole or roadway defect via the 311 Citizen Portal, mobile app, or dispatch desk, the DPW Road Maintenance Division requires **seven (7) specific data points** to triage, dispatch, and track the repair to completion:

REQUIRED FIELD	OPERATIONAL DESCRIPTION & SPECIFIC DETAILS	SYSTEM VALIDATION RULE
1. Exact Incident Location	Specific house address (e.g., *148 Valley Street*) or primary roadway with nearest cross-streets (e.g., *Baker St between Maplewood Ave and Ridgewood Rd*).	Matches municipal GIS address database.
2. Direction & Lane Position	Compass heading (Northbound, Southbound, Eastbound, Westbound) and exact lane: center travel lane, tire path, curb lane/gutter, or pedestrian crosswalk.	Identifies lane closure safety requirements.
3. Size & Severity Bracket	Citizen selects from three standard severity brackets: • **Tier 1 (<25 cm / <10"):** Shallow pitting / surface spall (<1" deep). • **Tier 2 (25–60 cm / 10–24"):** Medium pothole, depth 1–3". • **Tier 3 (>60 cm / >24"):** Large crater, depth >3" with exposed sub-base.	Tier 3 triggers immediate High Priority Dispatch Flag.
4. Jurisdiction Validation	Verification whether local municipal road or Essex County roadway (e.g., *Springfield Ave, Valley St, Wyoming Ave*). County roads automatically routed to County DPW with cross-reference tracking.	Prevents misplaced work orders.
5. Environmental & Hazards	Hazard flags: Standing water concealing hole depth, sharp jagged asphalt edges posing blowout risk, or encroachment on bicycle lanes or school crosswalks.	Water-filled cavities escalated to emergency triage.
6. Digital Photographs	Two (2) images: (1) Wide shot showing roadway location context, and (2) close-up shot showing cavity depth and pavement deterioration.	Geo-tag coordinates verified against location pin.
7. Citizen Contact Info	Reporter full name, telephone number (for SMS dispatch alerts), and email address. Generates automated tracking ID (`CASE-2026-XXXX`).	Anonymous reports accepted without live tracking.

OPERATIONAL RESPONSE SLAS & DUPLICATE SUPPRESSION

Pothole Response SLAs

Tier 3 / Travel Lane Craters: Dispatched within **24 hours** for emergency cold/hot-patch asphalt compaction.

Tier 1 & Tier 2 / Secondary Roads: Inspected and repaired within **3 to 5 business days** during scheduled ward sweep.

Automated Duplicate Suppression Rule

Submissions within a **50-meter geographic radius** logged within the prior **30 calendar days** are automatically consolidated into the active parent ticket.

New reporters are appended as subscribed citizens receiving real-time SMS updates without creating redundant crew dispatches.

Chapter 5: Additional 311 Service Categories & Work Order Lifecycle

The 311 Citizen Service Portal manages a comprehensive suite of public works, sanitation, and infrastructure service requests across the municipality:

SERVICE CATEGORY	MANDATORY REPORTING INFORMATION	OPERATIONAL RULES & SLA
Missed Waste & Recycling	• Full street address and collection zone (Sec 1–6) • Stream: Recycling, Organics, or Garbage • Confirmation bins were set out before 7:00 AM	**Strict 5:00 PM Cutoff:** Reports accepted strictly after 5:00 PM on collection day. **Resolution SLA:** 2 business days for re-collection sweep.
Streetlight Outages & Damage	• Six-digit pole tag stamped on metal plate (`ML-XXXX`) • Exact street address or closest house number • Condition: Lamp out, flickering, or exposed wiring	**Standard SLA:** 5 to 7 business days for lamp replacement. **Emergency SLA:** Exposed wiring dispatched within **24 hours**.
Boulevard Trees & Limbs	• Exact location of municipal tree on town right-of-way • Hazard type: Hanging limb, uprooted trunk, road obstruction • Digital photo showing proximity to lanes/wires	**Jurisdiction Rule:** Town maintains trees within **4.5 meters (14.8 ft) of curb**. **Emergency SLA:** 48 hours for hazards; 10 days for pruning.
Storm Drain Clogs & Floods	• Exact catch basin location / intersection • Water depth and surface coverage across roadway • Obstruction type: Leaf pack, branch debris, or silt	**Severe Storm Dispatch:** Roving vacuum truck crews dispatched immediately. Flooding >3 inches triggered as immediate road hazard.

THE 4-STAGE MUNICIPAL WORK ORDER STATUS LIFECYCLE

Every service request logged into the 311 system follows a transparent, four-stage lifecycle with real-time notifications dispatched via SMS or email:

Stage 1: Received (Status: New)

Request ingested into central database. GIS verification and duplicate check executed. Unique tracking ID (`CASE-2026-XXXX`) dispatched to citizen within 2 minutes.

Stage 2: Dispatched (Status: Assigned)

Work order reviewed by area maintenance supervisor and assigned to specific road crew, vacuum truck, or tree team. Route optimization scheduled by severity bracket.

Stage 3: In Progress (Status: Active)

Field crew actively on site. Safety perimeter established, asphalt compacted, or limb cleared. If secondary utility work required, ticket updated with sub-status.

Stage 4: Completed (Status: Closed)

Work inspected and approved by field foreman. Timestamped completion photo uploaded to ticket record. Citizen receives automated SMS/email resolution notice.

HOW CITIZENS CAN TRACK REAL-TIME 311 TICKETS:
Check live work order status 24/7 by visiting `maplewoodnj.gov/services/track` and entering your `CASE-2026-XXXX` number, or by texting **STATUS [CASE-NUMBER]** to **(555) 311-MAPL**.

Chapter 6: Prior Approvals, Fire Certificates & Master Fee Schedule

ZONING COMPLIANCE & CERTIFICATE OF SMOKE / CARBON MONOXIDE (CSDCMAC)

Zoning Prior Approval: Prior to obtaining construction permits for building additions, decks, pools, sheds, driveways, or fences, property owners must secure a **Zoning Permit** to certify compliance with building setbacks, building height maximums, and allowable impervious surface coverage.

Certificate of Smoke Detector & Carbon Monoxide Alarm Compliance (CSDCMAC): In accordance with N.J.A.C. 5:70-4.19, prior to the resale, lease, or change of occupancy of any residential dwelling, the owner must obtain a CSDCMAC inspection from the Maplewood Fire Department certifying operational smoke alarms on every level, carbon monoxide alarms outside sleeping areas, and an approved portable fire extinguisher in the kitchen.

MASTER MUNICIPAL PERMIT FEE SCHEDULE SUMMARY

MUNICIPAL PERMIT CATEGORY	STANDARD REVIEW FEE	STATUTORY REVIEW WINDOW	GOVERNING ORDINANCE / DEPARTMENT
Residential UCC Building Permit	$65.00 base + cubic/sq ft calculation	20 Business Days	NJ UCC (N.J.A.C. 5:23) / Construction Division
Residential Deck Construction Permit	$185.00 flat standard review	10 to 15 Business Days	Construction Division & Zoning
Swimming Pool Enclosure Permit	$150.00 standard review	10 Business Days	Construction Division (Building/Electric)
Residential Fence Zoning Permit	$50.00 flat review fee	10 Business Days	Zoning Division (Township Code Ch. 271)
Public Street Dumpster Permit	$50.00 per 7-day period	2 to 3 Business Days	DPW & Police Traffic Division
Private Tree Removal Permit (≥12" DBH)	$50.00 app + 1:1 replant or $375 Tree Fund	10 to 15 Business Days	Township Code Chapter 227 / DPW
Engineering Street Opening Permit	$175.00 base + bond calculation	10 Business Days	Engineering Department / DPW
Fire Safety CSDCMAC Resale Inspection	$50.00 – $125.00 (based on lead time)	5 Business Days	Fire Prevention Bureau (N.J.A.C. 5:70)

FEE WAIVER POLICY FOR EMERGENCY REPAIRS: In the event of catastrophic structural damage caused by declared natural disasters, severe storms, or emergency municipal sewer backups, filing fees for emergency structural stabilization permits may be waived by resolution of the Township Committee.

Chapter 7: Mandatory Inspection Milestones & Department Directory

THE 5 MANDATORY CONSTRUCTION INSPECTION MILESTONES

Under N.J.A.C. 5:23-2.18, work must not proceed beyond designated milestone stages without documented sign-off from licensed municipal subcode officials. Work covered prior to inspection is subject to mandatory stop-work orders and physical opening:

1. Bottom of Footing Inspection

Conducted prior to pouring concrete. Verifies excavation depth (min. 36" below finished grade for frost line), soil bearing integrity, pier hole dimensions, and rebar positioning.

2. Foundation & Underground Utilities

Conducted prior to backfilling foundation walls. Verifies wall parging, waterproofing, perimeter footing drains, sub-slab plumbing lines under pressure test, and anchor bolts.

3. Rough Framing, Plumbing & Electrical

Conducted after full structural frame, roof sheathing, rough wiring, and rough piping are installed. Must be approved BEFORE insulation or wallboard is hung.

4. Insulation & Thermal Envelope

Verifies R-value compliance (R-21 walls, R-49 attics), continuous vapor barriers, air-sealing of penetrations, and proper baffles at roof soffits prior to drywall installation.

5. Final Inspections & Certificate of Occupancy / Approval (CO / CA)

Conducted upon 100% completion of all construction, electrical, plumbing, mechanical, and fire protection scopes. Once all subcode inspectors sign the permit jacket, the Construction Official issues the formal **Certificate of Occupancy (CO)** or **Certificate of Approval (CA)**. Occupancy prior to CO issuance carries fines of up to $2,000 per week.

DEPARTMENTAL DIRECTORY & MUNICIPAL PERMIT CONTACT DESK

DEPARTMENT / MUNICIPAL OFFICE	TELEPHONE & EXTENSION	OFFICIAL EMAIL ADDRESS	OFFICE HOURS & LOCATION
Construction Division (UCC)	(973) 762-8120 Ext. 3100	construction@maplewoodnj.gov	Mon–Fri 8:30 AM – 4:30 PM • Town Hall
Engineering Department	(973) 762-8120 Ext. 3200	engineering@maplewoodnj.gov	Mon–Fri 8:30 AM – 4:30 PM • Town Hall
Zoning & Community Development	(973) 762-8120 Ext. 3300	zoning@maplewoodnj.gov	Mon–Fri 8:30 AM – 4:30 PM • Town Hall
Department of Public Works (DPW)	(973) 762-1175	publicworks@maplewoodnj.gov	Mon–Fri 8:00 AM – 3:00 PM • 359 Boyden Ave
311 Citizen Service & Pothole Desk	(555) 311-MAPL / 311	services311@maplewoodnj.gov	24/7 Digital Intake • Dispatch: (555) 123-7623
Fire Prevention Bureau	(973) 762-6500	fireprevention@maplewoodnj.gov	Mon–Fri 8:30 AM – 4:30 PM • Fire HQ

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